

Python Mastery — 100 Day Roadmap

Complete Python preparation: Core Python → DSA → Libraries → ML/AI/DL → Web Scraping
→ Big Tech Interview Prep

PHASE 1: Python Fundamentals

Setup & Basics

- ☒ Install Python & Setup environment
- ☒ Hello World with `print()`
- ☒ Using the Python REPL
- ☒ Variables and Assignment
- ☒ Data Types (int, float, str, bool)
- ☒ User Input (`input()`)
- ☒ Basic Math & Operators
- ☒ Type Checking & Conversion (`type()`, `str()`, `int()`, etc.)
- ☒ Simple Expressions
- ☐ Comments & Docstrings
- ☐ Constants & Naming Conventions
- ☐ Walrus operator `:=`

Control Flow

- ☒ If, Else, Elif
- ☒ Comparison & Logical Operators
- ☒ Conditional decisions
- ☒ While Loops
- ☒ For Loops & Ranges
- ☒ `break`, `continue`, `pass`
- ☒ Nested Loops
- ☐ Loop with `else` clause
- ☐ Match-case statements (Python 3.10+)

Functions

- ☐ Writing Functions (`def`, `return`)
- ☐ Parameters & Arguments
- ☐ Default Args, Keyword Args
- ☐ `*args` and `**kwargs`
- ☐ Docstrings
- ☐ Scope (LEGB rule)

- ☐ Lambda functions
 - ☐ Recursion basics
 - ☐ Closures
 - ☐ Decorators
 - ☐ Higher-order functions (`map`, `filter`, `reduce`)
 - ☐ Generator functions & `yield`
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PHASE 2: Data Structures (Built-in)

Lists

- ☐ Creation, Indexing, Slicing
- ☐ List Methods (`append`, `remove`, `pop`, `insert`, `extend`)
- ☐ List Comprehensions
- ☐ Nested Lists
- ☐ `enumerate()`, `zip()`
- ☐ Sorting (`sort`, `sorted`, custom keys)

Tuples

- ☐ Creation & Immutability
- ☐ Tuple unpacking
- ☐ Named tuples
- ☐ Tuple methods

Sets

- ☐ Creation & Operations
- ☐ Set methods (union, intersection, difference)
- ☐ Frozen sets
- ☐ Set comprehensions

Dictionaries

- ☐ Keys & Values
- ☐ Dict methods (`get`, `keys`, `values`, `items`, `update`)
- ☐ Dict comprehensions
- ☐ `defaultdict`, `OrderedDict`, `Counter`
- ☐ Nested dictionaries
- ☐ Merging dictionaries (`|` operator, `**` unpacking)

Strings

- ☐ String methods (`split`, `join`, `strip`, `replace`)

- ☐ String formatting (f-strings, `.format()`, `%`)
 - ☐ String slicing & indexing
 - ☐ Regular expressions (`re` module)
 - ☐ Encoding/Decoding (UTF-8, ASCII)
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PHASE 3: Python Practice Programs

Number Programs

- ☐ Counting digits of a number
- ☐ Sum of all digits
- ☐ Reversing digits
- ☐ Factorial (iterative + recursive)
- ☐ Fibonacci series
- ☐ Armstrong number
- ☐ Magic number
- ☐ Palindrome number
- ☐ Prime number check
- ☐ Prime numbers in range
- ☐ Power of a number
- ☐ GCD & LCM
- ☐ Perfect number
- ☐ Strong number
- ☐ Roots of quadratic equation
- ☐ Multiplication table
- ☐ Count down from a given number
- ☐ Number to English word

Array/List Programs

- ☐ Sum of array
- ☐ Max & Min of array
- ☐ Second maximum of array
- ☐ Second largest (distinct)
- ☐ Max-Min difference
- ☐ Search element (find index)
- ☐ Reverse list/array
- ☐ Left rotate by 1
- ☐ Right rotate by k
- ☐ Remove duplicates (unordered)
- ☐ Remove duplicates (keep order)

- ☐ Split positives/negatives
- ☐ Split even/odd by index
- ☐ Separate even/odd elements
- ☐ Sum of even/odd/prime elements
- ☐ Max of even/odd/prime elements
- ☐ Sorting array
- ☐ Merge two lists alternately
- ☐ Common elements in two lists
- ☐ Move zeroes to end
- ☐ Count occurrence of element
- ☐ Find largest element
- ☐ Find sum and average
- ☐ Even and odd lists
- ☐ Rotate list

String Programs

- ☐ Position of character in string
- ☐ Char frequency
- ☐ Vowel count
- ☐ Find vowels
- ☐ Palindrome string
- ☐ Remove duplicates
- ☐ Print without duplication
- ☐ Anagram test
- ☐ Count vowels and consonants
- ☐ Count words in sentence
- ☐ Word frequency counter
- ☐ Reverse words in sentence
- ☐ Longest word in sentence

Matrix Programs

- ☐ Create & print matrix
- ☐ Transpose
- ☐ Diagonal sum
- ☐ Identity check
- ☐ Add/Subtract/Multiply matrices
- ☐ Spiral traversal
- ☐ Rotate matrix 90°

Dictionary Programs

- ☐ Access & count
- ☐ Swap key/value
- ☐ Filter by value
- ☐ Merge dictionaries
- ☐ Phonebook implementation

Tuple/Set Programs

- ☐ Find max/min in tuple
 - ☐ Common elements in two sets
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PHASE 4: Searching & Sorting Algorithms

Searching

- ☐ Linear Search
- ☐ Binary Search (iterative)
- ☐ Binary Search (recursive)
- ☐ Ternary Search
- ☐ Jump Search
- ☐ Interpolation Search
- ☐ Exponential Search

Sorting

- ☐ Bubble Sort
 - ☐ Selection Sort
 - ☐ Insertion Sort
 - ☐ Merge Sort
 - ☐ Quick Sort
 - ☐ Counting Sort
 - ☐ Radix Sort
 - ☐ Heap Sort
 - ☐ Bucket Sort
 - ☐ Shell Sort
 - ☐ Time complexity comparison of all sorts
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PHASE 5: Object-Oriented Programming

- ☐ Classes & Objects

- ☐ `__init__` constructor
 - ☐ Instance vs Class Attributes
 - ☐ Methods (instance, class, static)
 - ☐ Encapsulation (private/protected)
 - ☐ Inheritance (single, multiple, multilevel)
 - ☐ Method Overriding
 - ☐ Method Resolution Order (MRO)
 - ☐ Polymorphism
 - ☐ Abstraction & ABC module
 - ☐ Dunder/Magic methods (`__str__`, `__repr__`, `__eq__`, etc.)
 - ☐ Operator overloading
 - ☐ Property decorators (`@property`)
 - ☐ Dataclasses
 - ☐ `__slots__` for memory optimization
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PHASE 6: Intermediate & Advanced Python

File Handling

- ☐ Reading files (`open`, `with`)
- ☐ Writing & appending files
- ☐ Reading line by line
- ☐ Working with CSV (`csv` module)
- ☐ Working with JSON (`json` module)
- ☐ Working with XML
- ☐ Pickle (object serialization)
- ☐ Working with paths (`os.path`, `pathlib`)

Error Handling

- ☐ try / except / finally
- ☐ Multiple except blocks
- ☐ `raise` custom exceptions
- ☐ Custom exception classes
- ☐ Context managers (`with` statement)
- ☐ Creating context managers (`__enter__`, `__exit__`)

Iterators & Generators

- ☐ Iterator protocol (`__iter__`, `__next__`)
- ☐ Generator functions
- ☐ Generator expressions

- ☐ `itertools` module deep dive
- ☐ `functools` module (`lru_cache`, `partial`, `reduce`)

Modules & Packages

- ☐ Importing modules
- ☐ Creating modules
- ☐ `__name__ == "__main__"`
- ☐ Creating packages (`__init__.py`)
- ☐ Installing with pip
- ☐ Virtual environments (`venv`, `virtualenv`)
- ☐ `requirements.txt` & `pip freeze`
- ☐ Poetry / uv (modern package managers)

Concurrency & Parallelism

- ☐ Threading (`threading` module)
- ☐ Multiprocessing (`multiprocessing`)
- ☐ Async/Await (`asyncio`)
- ☐ `concurrent.futures`
- ☐ GIL (Global Interpreter Lock) understanding
- ☐ Locks, Semaphores, Queues

Advanced Features

- ☐ Type hints (`typing` module)
 - ☐ Pydantic for data validation
 - ☐ Memory management & garbage collection
 - ☐ `__new__` vs `__init__`
 - ☐ Metaclasses
 - ☐ Descriptors
 - ☐ Monkey patching
 - ☐ Profiling (`cProfile`, `timeit`)
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PHASE 7: Data Structures & Algorithms (Big Tech Interview Prep)

Arrays & Strings

- ☐ Two pointers technique
- ☐ Sliding window
- ☐ Prefix sum
- ☐ Kadane's algorithm
- ☐ Dutch national flag problem

- ☐ Trapping rain water
- ☐ Longest substring without repeating characters
- ☐ String matching (KMP, Rabin-Karp)

Linked Lists

- ☐ Singly linked list (implementation)
- ☐ Doubly linked list
- ☐ Circular linked list
- ☐ Reverse linked list
- ☐ Detect cycle (Floyd's algorithm)
- ☐ Merge two sorted lists
- ☐ LRU Cache implementation

Stacks & Queues

- ☐ Stack implementation
- ☐ Queue implementation
- ☐ Deque (`collections.deque`)
- ☐ Priority Queue / Heap (`heapq`)
- ☐ Monotonic stack
- ☐ Next greater element
- ☐ Valid parentheses

Trees

- ☐ Binary Tree implementation
- ☐ Tree traversals (inorder, preorder, postorder)
- ☐ Level order traversal (BFS)
- ☐ Binary Search Tree (BST)
- ☐ AVL Tree (basics)
- ☐ Tree height & diameter
- ☐ Lowest Common Ancestor (LCA)
- ☐ Serialize / Deserialize tree
- ☐ Trie (prefix tree)
- ☐ Segment tree (basics)
- ☐ Fenwick tree / BIT (basics)

Graphs

- ☐ Graph representation (adjacency list/matrix)
- ☐ BFS traversal
- ☐ DFS traversal
- ☐ Detect cycle in graph

- ☐ Topological sort
- ☐ Dijkstra's algorithm
- ☐ Bellman-Ford
- ☐ Floyd-Warshall
- ☐ Prim's & Kruskal's MST
- ☐ Union-Find (DSU)
- ☐ Strongly connected components

Dynamic Programming

- ☐ Memoization vs Tabulation
- ☐ Fibonacci DP
- ☐ 0/1 Knapsack
- ☐ Unbounded Knapsack
- ☐ Longest Common Subsequence
- ☐ Longest Increasing Subsequence
- ☐ Edit Distance
- ☐ Coin Change
- ☐ Matrix Chain Multiplication
- ☐ DP on trees
- ☐ DP on grids

Greedy & Backtracking

- ☐ Activity selection
- ☐ Huffman coding
- ☐ N-Queens
- ☐ Sudoku solver
- ☐ Permutations & Combinations
- ☐ Subset sum

Bit Manipulation

- ☐ AND, OR, XOR, NOT, shifts
- ☐ Check power of 2
- ☐ Count set bits
- ☐ Single number problems
- ☐ Bitmask DP

Math & Number Theory

- ☐ Sieve of Eratosthenes
- ☐ GCD/LCM (Euclidean algorithm)
- ☐ Modular arithmetic

- ☐ Fast exponentiation
- ☐ Prime factorization

Big O & Complexity Analysis

- ☐ Time complexity analysis
 - ☐ Space complexity analysis
 - ☐ Amortized analysis
 - ☐ Recurrence relations & Master theorem
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PHASE 8: NumPy (Numerical Computing)

- ☐ Installation & import conventions
 - ☐ Creating arrays (`array`, `zeros`, `ones`, `arange`, `linspace`)
 - ☐ Array attributes (shape, dtype, ndim, size)
 - ☐ Indexing & slicing
 - ☐ Boolean indexing & fancy indexing
 - ☐ Reshaping (`reshape`, `flatten`, `ravel`)
 - ☐ Stacking (`vstack`, `hstack`, `concatenate`)
 - ☐ Splitting arrays
 - ☐ Broadcasting rules
 - ☐ Arithmetic operations
 - ☐ Universal functions (ufuncs)
 - ☐ Aggregations (`sum`, `mean`, `std`, `min`, `max`)
 - ☐ Linear algebra (`np.linalg`)
 - ☐ Random module (`np.random`)
 - ☐ Saving/loading arrays (`np.save`, `np.load`)
 - ☐ Performance vs Python lists
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PHASE 9: Pandas (Data Analysis)

- ☐ Series creation & operations
- ☐ DataFrame creation
- ☐ Reading data (CSV, Excel, JSON, SQL, Parquet)
- ☐ Writing data
- ☐ Inspecting data (`head`, `tail`, `info`, `describe`)
- ☐ Selecting columns & rows
- ☐ `loc` vs `iloc`
- ☐ Filtering data (boolean indexing)
- ☐ Adding/removing columns

- ☐ Handling missing data (`isna`, `fillna`, `dropna`)
 - ☐ Data types & conversions
 - ☐ String operations (`.str` accessor)
 - ☐ Date/time operations (`.dt` accessor)
 - ☐ Sorting (`sort_values`, `sort_index`)
 - ☐ GroupBy operations
 - ☐ Aggregations & transformations
 - ☐ Pivot tables & cross-tabs
 - ☐ Merging & joining (`merge`, `join`, `concat`)
 - ☐ Apply, map, applymap
 - ☐ Window functions (`rolling`, `expanding`)
 - ☐ MultiIndex / hierarchical indexing
 - ☐ Performance optimization tips
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PHASE 10: Data Visualization

Matplotlib

- ☐ Basic plot, scatter, bar
- ☐ Histograms & box plots
- ☐ Multiple subplots
- ☐ Customizing plots (labels, legend, colors)
- ☐ Saving figures

Seaborn

- ☐ Statistical plots (distplot, heatmap, pairplot)
- ☐ Categorical plots
- ☐ Themes & styling

Plotly (Interactive)

- ☐ Plotly Express basics
 - ☐ Interactive charts
 - ☐ Dashboards
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PHASE 11: Web Scraping & Automation

Requests & BeautifulSoup

- ☐ HTTP basics (GET, POST, headers, cookies)
- ☐ `requests` library

- ☐ Parsing HTML with BeautifulSoup
- ☐ Selecting elements (CSS selectors, find, find_all)
- ☐ Handling pagination
- ☐ Sessions & authentication

Selenium

- ☐ Browser automation setup
- ☐ WebDriver basics
- ☐ Locating elements
- ☐ Interactions (click, type, scroll)
- ☐ Waits (implicit/explicit)
- ☐ Headless browsing

Playwright

- ☐ Installation & setup
- ☐ Sync vs Async API
- ☐ Page navigation & interactions
- ☐ Selectors (CSS, XPath, text)
- ☐ Auto-waiting
- ☐ Screenshots & PDFs
- ☐ Network interception
- ☐ Multiple browser contexts
- ☐ Headless vs headed mode
- ☐ Handling iframes & shadow DOM

Scrapy (Production-grade)

- ☐ Spider basics
- ☐ Items & pipelines
- ☐ Middlewares
- ☐ Scrapy shell

Automation

- ☐ PyAutoGUI for GUI automation
 - ☐ `os` & `shutil` for file automation
 - ☐ `schedule` for task scheduling
 - ☐ Sending emails (`smtplib`)
 - ☐ WhatsApp/Telegram bot APIs
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PHASE 12: Databases with Python

- ☐ SQLite with `sqlite3`
 - ☐ MySQL/PostgreSQL with connectors
 - ☐ SQLAlchemy ORM basics
 - ☐ CRUD operations
 - ☐ MongoDB with `pymongo`
 - ☐ Redis with `redis-py`
 - ☐ Supabase Python client
 - ☐ Database migrations (Alembic)
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PHASE 13: APIs & Web Development

Building APIs

- ☐ FastAPI basics
- ☐ Path & query parameters
- ☐ Request body & Pydantic models
- ☐ Authentication (JWT, OAuth)
- ☐ Middleware
- ☐ Dependency injection
- ☐ Async endpoints
- ☐ Background tasks
- ☐ WebSockets
- ☐ Flask basics (alternative)
- ☐ Django basics (alternative)

Consuming APIs

- ☐ REST API calls with `requests`
 - ☐ Async calls with `httpx` / `aiohttp`
 - ☐ Working with JSON responses
 - ☐ Error handling & retries
 - ☐ Rate limiting
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PHASE 14: Machine Learning

Scikit-learn

- ☐ ML workflow overview
- ☐ Train/test split

- ☐ Feature scaling (StandardScaler, MinMaxScaler)
- ☐ Encoding categoricals (OneHot, Label)
- ☐ Pipelines

Supervised Learning

- ☐ Linear Regression
- ☐ Logistic Regression
- ☐ K-Nearest Neighbors (KNN)
- ☐ Decision Trees
- ☐ Random Forest
- ☐ Gradient Boosting (XGBoost, LightGBM, CatBoost)
- ☐ Support Vector Machines (SVM)
- ☐ Naive Bayes

Unsupervised Learning

- ☐ K-Means Clustering
- ☐ Hierarchical Clustering
- ☐ DBSCAN
- ☐ PCA (Dimensionality Reduction)
- ☐ t-SNE / UMAP

Model Evaluation

- ☐ Accuracy, Precision, Recall, F1
- ☐ Confusion matrix
- ☐ ROC-AUC
- ☐ Cross-validation
- ☐ Hyperparameter tuning (GridSearch, RandomSearch)
- ☐ Bias-variance tradeoff
- ☐ Overfitting & regularization (L1, L2)

Feature Engineering

- ☐ Handling missing values
 - ☐ Outlier detection
 - ☐ Feature selection
 - ☐ Feature creation
 - ☐ Encoding strategies
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PHASE 15: Deep Learning

PyTorch

- ☐ Tensors basics
- ☐ Tensor operations & broadcasting
- ☐ Autograd & gradient computation
- ☐ Building neural networks (`nn.Module`)
- ☐ Loss functions
- ☐ Optimizers (SGD, Adam, etc.)
- ☐ Training loop
- ☐ DataLoader & Dataset
- ☐ GPU/CUDA usage
- ☐ Saving & loading models
- ☐ Transfer learning

TensorFlow / Keras (alternative)

- ☐ Sequential & Functional API
- ☐ Building models
- ☐ Training & evaluation

Neural Network Architectures

- ☐ Feedforward NN (MLP)
- ☐ Convolutional NN (CNN)
- ☐ Recurrent NN (RNN, LSTM, GRU)
- ☐ Transformers (attention mechanism)
- ☐ Autoencoders
- ☐ GANs (basics)

Deep Learning Concepts

- ☐ Activation functions (ReLU, Sigmoid, Tanh, GELU)
 - ☐ Backpropagation
 - ☐ Batch normalization
 - ☐ Dropout
 - ☐ Learning rate scheduling
 - ☐ Gradient clipping
 - ☐ Weight initialization
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PHASE 16: NLP & Computer Vision

NLP

- ☐ Tokenization, stemming, lemmatization
- ☐ NLTK & spaCy basics
- ☐ Bag of Words, TF-IDF
- ☐ Word embeddings (Word2Vec, GloVe)
- ☐ HuggingFace Transformers
- ☐ Fine-tuning BERT/GPT
- ☐ Text classification
- ☐ Named Entity Recognition (NER)

Computer Vision

- ☐ OpenCV basics
 - ☐ Image processing (resize, filters, edge detection)
 - ☐ Pillow (PIL)
 - ☐ Image augmentation
 - ☐ Object detection (YOLO basics)
 - ☐ Image classification with CNNs
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PHASE 17: LLMs & Generative AI

- ☐ OpenAI API
 - ☐ Anthropic Claude API
 - ☐ Google Gemini API
 - ☐ Prompt engineering basics
 - ☐ LangChain framework
 - ☐ LlamaIndex
 - ☐ RAG (Retrieval Augmented Generation)
 - ☐ Vector databases (Pinecone, Chroma, Weaviate)
 - ☐ Embeddings & similarity search
 - ☐ Function calling / tool use
 - ☐ Agents & multi-agent systems
 - ☐ Streaming responses
 - ☐ Token counting & cost optimization
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PHASE 18: MLOps & Deployment

- ☐ Saving/loading ML models (pickle, joblib)

- ☐ Model serving with FastAPI
 - ☐ Docker basics for Python
 - ☐ Streamlit for ML demos
 - ☐ Gradio for ML demos
 - ☐ MLflow for experiment tracking
 - ☐ Weights & Biases (wandb)
 - ☐ Deploying to cloud (AWS, GCP, Azure basics)
 - ☐ Hugging Face Spaces
 - ☐ Vercel / Render for Python apps
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PHASE 19: Testing & Code Quality

- ☐ `unittest` framework
 - ☐ `pytest` framework
 - ☐ Fixtures & parametrize
 - ☐ Mocking (`unittest.mock`)
 - ☐ Code coverage
 - ☐ Type checking with `mypy`
 - ☐ Linting (`flake8`, `pylint`, `ruff`)
 - ☐ Formatting (`black`, `isort`)
 - ☐ Pre-commit hooks
 - ☐ Logging (`logging` module)
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PHASE 20: Important Python Libraries (Quick Reference)

Standard Library Essentials

- ☐ `os`, `sys`, `pathlib`
- ☐ `datetime`, `time`, `calendar`
- ☐ `collections` (Counter, defaultdict, deque, OrderedDict)
- ☐ `itertools`, `functools`
- ☐ `re` (regex)
- ☐ `json`, `csv`, `pickle`
- ☐ `random`, `math`, `statistics`
- ☐ `argparse`, `sys.argv`
- ☐ `subprocess`
- ☐ `urllib`

Third-Party Must-Knows

- ☐ `requests` — HTTP
 - ☐ `numpy` — Numerical
 - ☐ `pandas` — Data
 - ☐ `matplotlib` / `seaborn` — Plotting
 - ☐ `scikit-learn` — ML
 - ☐ `pytorch` / `tensorflow` — DL
 - ☐ `transformers` — NLP/LLMs
 - ☐ `fastapi` — APIs
 - ☐ `pydantic` — Validation
 - ☐ `sqlalchemy` — ORM
 - ☐ `playwright` / `selenium` — Browser automation
 - ☐ `beautifulsoup4` — HTML parsing
 - ☐ `pytest` — Testing
 - ☐ `rich` — Terminal output
 - ☐ `tqdm` — Progress bars
 - ☐ `python-dotenv` — Env vars
 - ☐ `pillow` — Images
 - ☐ `opencv-python` — CV
 - ☐ `streamlit` — Quick UIs
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PHASE 21: Big Tech Interview Prep (Python-Specific)

Coding Patterns (LeetCode-style)

- ☐ Two Pointers
- ☐ Sliding Window
- ☐ Fast & Slow Pointers
- ☐ Merge Intervals
- ☐ Cyclic Sort
- ☐ In-place Reversal of Linked List
- ☐ Tree BFS / DFS
- ☐ Two Heaps
- ☐ Subsets / Backtracking
- ☐ Modified Binary Search
- ☐ Top K Elements
- ☐ K-way Merge
- ☐ 0/1 Knapsack DP
- ☐ Topological Sort

System Design (Python perspective)

- ☐ Designing a URL shortener
- ☐ Designing a rate limiter
- ☐ Designing a cache (LRU/LFU)
- ☐ Designing a message queue
- ☐ Designing a notification system
- ☐ Database sharding & replication basics
- ☐ Microservices vs Monolith
- ☐ Caching strategies
- ☐ Load balancing concepts

Python Interview Trivia

- ☐ Mutable vs immutable types
- ☐ Shallow vs deep copy
- ☐ `is` vs `==`
- ☐ GIL deep dive
- ☐ How dict/set work internally (hashing)
- ☐ Memory model & reference counting
- ☐ Generator vs Iterator
- ☐ `*args` vs `**kwargs`
- ☐ Decorators & closures (in-depth)
- ☐ Context managers (in-depth)
- ☐ Metaclasses
- ☐ Class vs static vs instance methods
- ☐ Multiple inheritance & MRO
- ☐ `__slots__` use cases
- ☐ Common Python gotchas (mutable default args, late binding)

Behavioral & Resume Prep

- ☐ STAR method for behavioral questions
- ☐ Building a Python project portfolio
- ☐ GitHub README best practices
- ☐ Open-source contributions

PHASE 22: Capstone Projects (Apply Everything)

- ☐ CLI tool (with `argparse` / `click`)
- ☐ Web scraper (Playwright + Pandas)
- ☐ REST API (FastAPI + DB)

- ☐ ML model + deployment (Streamlit/Gradio)
 - ☐ LLM-powered app (RAG with vector DB)
 - ☐ Telegram/Discord bot
 - ☐ Data analysis dashboard
 - ☐ End-to-end DL project (CV or NLP)
 - ☐ Automation script for real workflow
 - ☐ Open-source contribution
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Tip: Don't rush phases. Build small projects after each phase to lock in concepts. For interviews, target ~150-200 LeetCode problems across the patterns above.